

Making the most of Windows Calendar

Share your calendar with friends, keep track of dates and appointments, and much more

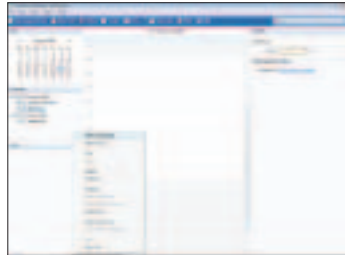
For a long time, anyone who wanted to use their computer to manage their diary had to turn to dedicated third-party tools such as Microsoft Office Outlook, since pre-Vista Windows lacked even the most basic calendar function. Now, however, all versions of Vista come with Windows Calendar.

Using Windows Calendar's advanced features, it is possible to create multiple calendars so personal and business appointments can be kept separate. Calendars can even be created in groups as required, shared with others via email, or published to a web server.

There is also the option of subscribing to calendars that have been created by others — either shared calendars belonging to friends and family, or lists of sporting fixtures and other event schedules. Here we explore Windows Calendar's advanced features.

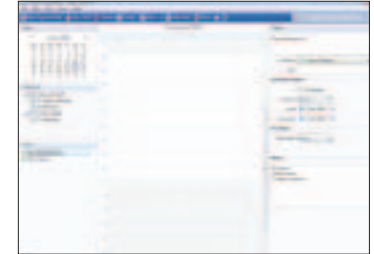
Step 1

By default, Windows Calendar creates a single calendar that has the same name as your user account. Additional calendars can be created as required, making it easy to keep track of dates and appointments without cluttering a single calendar. Click the **File** menu and select **New Calendar** before entering a name and pressing **Enter**. There is no limit to the number of calendars that can be created, but when several exist, they can become difficult to manage. To simplify things, calendars can be organised into groups. Click the **File** menu and select **New Group**. Groups and calendars can also be created by right-clicking within the **Calendars** pane and selecting the relevant option. You can organise them by dragging and dropping calendars into any group that has been created.



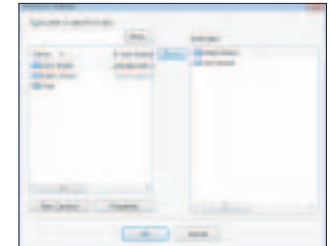
Step 2

Windows Calendar allows for the creation of both appointments and tasks. Appointments can be regarded as traditional diary entries for events that take place on a particular day, at a specific time. Tasks are more long-term events and projects that may have a more open-ended start and finish date. Create a new task by either clicking the **New Task** button at the top of the screen, or by right-clicking in the **Task** pane and selecting **New Task** before entering details to the right. Use the **Calendar** menu to select which calendar the task should be added to, and set the priority, along with start and end dates. Once a task has been accomplished, tick the **Completed** box in the right-hand pane or the box next to an item in the **Task** pane.



Step 3

Appointments can be created in a similar way. Either click the **New Appointment** toolbar button or right-click within the calendar pane and select **New Appointment**. After filling in the event details in the right-hand panel, either choose between assigning a particular time to the appointment or setting it up as an all-day event. Appointments that occur on a regular basis can be configured by making a selection from the **Recurrence** menu, along with choosing when a reminder should be displayed. To invite other people to an appointment, click the **Attendees** button, select the contact to invite, or create new ones, then click **OK**, followed by **Invite**. An email will then be sent out to the selected contacts.



Step 4

To send an entire calendar to someone, either click the **Share** menu and select **'Send via E-mail'**, or right-click the relevant calendar in the **Calendars** pane and select the option with the same label. Enter the email address(es) that the calendar should be sent to, and send out the email. The recipient need sim-